

AICT Global Services Inc.

Impartiality Policy

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POL-001	1.1	Approved	September 29, 2026

Prepared By	Reviewed By	Approved By
K. Kelly	J. Kelly	K. Kelly

Rev	Date	Author	Description
1.0	March 13, 2026	K. Kelly	Initial draft
1.1	September 29, 2026	K. Kelly	Section 6.1 re cited to Clauses 5.2.3 and 6.1.4 (Clause 8.4 is confidentiality); committee described as established under Board approved terms of reference; Directors wording aligned with PER-002; ISO/IEC 42006:2025 designation corrected; status Approved.

1. Purpose

This policy establishes the commitment of AICT Global Services Inc. to impartial certification activities and defines the mechanisms by which threats to impartiality are identified, assessed, mitigated, and monitored in accordance with ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 4.2 and Clause 5.2.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all personnel, contractors, committee members, and any other parties involved in the certification activities of AICT Global Services Inc., including application review, audit planning, audit conduct, certification decisions, surveillance, and recertification.

3. Policy Statement

AICT Global Services Inc. is committed to ensuring that certification activities are conducted impartially, free from commercial, financial, or other pressures that could compromise the integrity of certification outcomes. Certification decisions are based solely on objective evidence of conformity (or nonconformity) with applicable certification requirements.

Top management publicly commits to impartiality and ensures that this commitment is understood and implemented throughout the organization.

4. Threats to Impartiality

The following categories of threats are systematically identified and assessed:

- Self interest threat: Arising from a person or body acting in their own interest. This includes financial relationships with clients, dependence on certification fees, or conflicts arising from related entity revenue.
- Self review threat: Arising from a person or body reviewing work done by themselves. This includes situations where audit team members previously provided consulting or advisory services to the client.
- Familiarity (or trust) threat: Arising from a person or body being too familiar with or trusting of another person instead of seeking objective evidence.
- Intimidation threat: Arising from a person or body having a perception of being coerced, overtly or covertly.

5. Related Entities and Structural Separation

AICT Global Services Inc. is structurally related to the following entities: ascio Advisory Services (technology governance and certification readiness advisory) and Unlock Solutions (enterprise AI enablement and transformation consulting). The two Directors of AICT, K. Kelly and J. Kelly, co own both entities and hold leadership roles in them.

These relationships represent a significant self review and self interest threat to impartiality. The following mandatory controls are implemented:

5.1 Two Year Cooling Off Period

No personnel who have provided management system consulting, advisory, internal audit, or training services to a client organization (whether through ascio Advisory Services, Unlock Solutions, or any other capacity) shall participate in any certification activity for that same client until a minimum of two (2) years have elapsed since the conclusion of the consulting/advisory engagement.

5.2 Operational and Financial Separation

- Certification decisions are never influenced by advisory revenue, client relationships, or commercial interests of related entities.
- Financial records for certification activities are maintained separately from advisory/consulting activities.
- No shared client management, sales pipelines, or cross referral incentives exist between AICT certification activities and advisory activities of any related entity.
- Client applications include a mandatory consultancy disclosure requiring applicants to declare any advisory or consulting relationship with AICT, related advisory entities, or their personnel within the preceding two years.

5.3 Personnel Controls

- All personnel sign an impartiality and conflict of interest declaration annually and before each audit engagement.
- Personnel are required to disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest immediately upon becoming aware of it.
- Audit team assignment includes a conflict-of-interest screening step documented in PRO-001 Certification Process Procedure.

5.4 ISMS Specific Impartiality (ISO/IEC 27006-1:2024, 5.2.2)

AICT shall not provide internal IS reviews of client ISMS subject to AICT certification. AICT is independent from any body or individual providing the internal ISMS audit. Opportunities for improvement identified during audits may be communicated without recommending specific solutions.

5.5 AIMS Specific Impartiality (ISO/IEC 42006:2025, 5.2.2)

Category	Activities	Clause
Prohibited	Consulting for AI, IS, data protection, or risk management to 42001 clients	5.2.2.1
Prohibited	Company specific advice as consultancy	5.2.2.3 a
Prohibited	Audit like activities or recommendations that reduce audit time	5.2.2.3 b
Prohibited	Recommending specific AIMS, AI system, or AI process solutions	5.2.2.3 c
Prohibited	Internal audits for clients, including renamed as inspection/assessment	5.2.2.3
Permitted	Publicly available AI MS training courses (not in house/client specific)	5.2.2.2 a
Permitted	Pre audit scope and readiness determination	5.2.2.2 b

The CSI specifically reviews AIMS impartiality threats: prior AI consulting relationships, AI technology partnerships, AI training provided to specific clients, and financial interest in AI products/services used by clients.

6. Committee for Safeguarding Impartiality (CSI)

6.1 Purpose

In accordance with ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015 Clause 5.2.3 (balanced consultation with interested parties) and Clause 6.1.4 (formal rules for committees), AICT Global Services Inc. has established a Committee for Safeguarding Impartiality (CSI) to provide independent oversight of certification activities and advise on matters relating to impartiality.

6.2 Composition

The CSI includes representatives of key interested parties, ensuring balanced representation. Members are appointed by the Board of Directors under the committee terms of reference, which set the appointment, term, quorum and meeting frequency. Membership shall not be dominated by any single interest. The CSI operates independently of the certification body's management and commercial functions.

6.3 Responsibilities

- Review and advise on the impartiality policy and its implementation.
- Monitor threats to impartiality and the effectiveness of mitigation measures.
- Review any situations where impartiality may have been compromised and recommend corrective action.
- Review the relationship between AICT Global Services Inc. and its related entities to ensure adequate structural separation.
- Provide input to management review on impartiality matters.
- Access all information necessary to fulfil its oversight function.

6.4 Authority

If the CSI determines that the certification body has failed to take appropriate action regarding impartiality, the committee has the authority to take independent action (e.g., informing SCC or other regulatory bodies). Top management commits to not restricting the CSI's access to information or its ability to exercise its oversight function.

7. Risk Assessment and Mitigation

Threats to impartiality are assessed as part of the risk management process (PRO-007 Risk Management Procedure). For each identified threat, the following are documented:

- Description of the threat and the parties involved.
- Assessment of the severity and likelihood of the threat.
- Mitigation measures implemented.
- Residual risk after mitigation.
- Monitoring and review arrangements.

The impartiality risk register is reviewed by the CSI and during management review.

7.1 Impartiality Risk Register: Related Entity Entries

The following related entity risks are recorded in the impartiality risk register:

Field	ascio Advisory Services	Unlock Solutions
Nature of relationship	Shared Directors (K. Kelly and J. Kelly co own and lead both AICT and ascio)	Shared Directors (K. Kelly and J. Kelly co own and lead both AICT and Unlock Solutions)
Nature of services	Technology governance and certification readiness advisory services	Enterprise AI enablement and transformation consulting
Identified threat	Clients of ascio may seek certification from AICT, creating a self review or familiarity threat	Clients of Unlock Solutions may seek certification from AICT, creating a self review or familiarity threat

Safeguards in place	Mandatory two year cooling off period before any personnel involved in advisory or consulting for a client may participate in AICT certification activities for that client; Engagement level conflict of interest screening at application review; Separate legal entities with separate financial accounts; Separate Microsoft 365 tenants with no shared data or systems; CSI review of all related entity relationships at each meeting; Annual declaration of interests by all AICT personnel.	Mandatory two year cooling off period before any personnel involved in advisory or consulting for a client may participate in AICT certification activities for that client; Engagement level conflict of interest screening at application review; Separate legal entities with separate financial accounts; Separate Microsoft 365 tenants with no shared data or systems; CSI review of all related entity relationships at each meeting; Annual declaration of interests by all AICT personnel.
Risk rating after safeguards	Low	Low
Disclosed to CSI	Yes, date of initial disclosure to be recorded at first CSI meeting	Yes, date of initial disclosure to be recorded at first CSI meeting

8. Public Availability

This policy is publicly available on the AICT Global Services Inc. website at <https://www.aictglobalservices.com> and is provided to any interested party upon request.

9. Review

This policy is reviewed at least annually as part of the management review process or whenever significant changes occur that may affect impartiality.

Approval

Approval of this document signifies that it is suitable for its intended purpose and has been issued under PRO-006 Document Control Procedure.

Role	Name and Title	Signature	Date
Approved by	K. Kelly Director, Quality Manager and Lead Auditor		
Reviewed by	J. Kelly Director, Lead Auditor and Certification Decision Maker		